

TEACHER KEY · NOT FOR STUDENTS

Character Development

Sample answers · Weeks 1–6

Mr. Fung · EIPS · 2026–2027

1. Week 1 — My volunteer map
2. Week 2 — My experience map (private)
3. Week 3 — Perseverance plan (one hard thing)
4. Week 4 — Skill-to-contribution match
5. Week 5 — My protective-factor card
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Week 1: Volunteering – Time, Talent, and Energy

My volunteer map

Volunteering = giving time, talent, or energy to help people or community.

1. One skill or strength I already have

I am good at organizing bins and making clear signs. I notice when the lost-and-found is a mess.

2. Who or what could that help? (school, family, community, land, animals)

Our school hallway and younger students who lose mittens. Also the lunch supervisors who currently have to dig through the pile.

What I would do / Time, talent, or energy? / Who benefits

Stay 20 minutes Thursdays to fold lost-and-found and make a claim-your-stuff sign

Time + talent (organizing) + energy

Grade 3s, office staff, anyone who lost a hat

4. One thing that might get in the way (transport, shyness, time) and one way around it

I might miss the late bus. I can ask if I can start at 3:05 and still catch the 3:25 bus, or do it at lunch on Friday instead.

Exit ticket — In one sentence: How could volunteering support your well-being or someone else's?

Helping the lost-and-found makes me feel useful, and younger kids feel looked after when they get their hats back.

Look-fors

- Can the student define volunteering in their own words (time, talent, or energy — not pay)?
- Did they name one realistic Grade 5 contribution?
- Can they say who would benefit?

Tip. Keep ideas local and doable. Avoid “save the world” lists. School jobs count: recycling, younger-buddy reading, set-up crew. Never require unpaid labour as a grade.

Week 2: Life Experiences Shape Who We Are

My experience map (private)

Use school-appropriate examples. You do not have to write about anything painful. Everyday experiences count.

The experience / Skill or strength it built

Freezing in a spelling bee at my old school, then practising out loud here

Asking for a warm-up instead of pretending I am fine

2. One experience that shaped a preference (how I like to learn, play, or rest)

I like a quiet rehearsal with a partner before I have to perform in front of the class.

3. How might that experience change the way I respond when something similar happens again?

If I feel panic before a quiz or a game, I will ask for practise time instead of shutting down or sitting out.

4. Optional to share with a partner: one sentence I am willing to say out loud

I like a warm-up before I perform.

Exit ticket — Finish: Life experiences can shape our understanding because _____.

they teach us skills and how we read a new situation, like asking for practise after a freeze.

Look-fors

- Did the student name an experience and a skill or preference that came from it?
- Can they explain, in one line, that experiences influence how we respond?
- Did they keep classmates' stories private?

Tip. Model a mild personal example first. If a student writes something that sounds like a safety disclosure, follow EIPS reporting — do not put it under the document camera.

Week 3: Perseverance — Staying With Hard Things

Perseverance plan (one hard thing)

The hard thing (school-appropriate)

Getting a clean high B on recorder before band on Fridays.

Support / What this could look like for me this week

Effort: Effort: six extra minutes at lunch with the fingering chart.

Courage: Courage: play the squeaky note in front of two friends.

Commitment (including rest): Commitment: rest my jaw, come back Thursday.

Belief I can improve: Belief: High B gets cleaner if I slow down.

One person or tool that could help (not “try harder”)

Mr. Kwan’s fingering chart taped inside the case, and sitting in the second row to watch his fingers.

Exit ticket — How could perseverance on this thing support your well-being? (mood, confidence, health, belonging)

I dread band less, I feel more able, and I still belong in the group even when the note is not perfect yet.

Look-fors

- Can the student tell perseverance from “pretend it is easy”?
- Did they name a concrete action, not only “don’t give up”?
- Did they include a help source or a rest plan?

Tip. Watch for students who confuse perseverance with never asking for help. Praise “I tried a new strategy” more than “I suffered longer.”

Week 4: Strengths, Skills, and Community Contribution

Skill-to-contribution match

A skill or knowledge I have / A community need it could help / School or community idea

Remembering names and noticing who is left out

New students feeling lost

Friday welcome walk with the office

My realistic try this month (one idea, with when and who I would ask)

Ask Ms. Patel this Friday if I can join the new-kid tour crew, twenty minutes, with one other student.

How this links to perseverance (what might be awkward at first)

The first time will feel awkward. Commitment includes coming back after a wobble.

Exit ticket — Complete: I can contribute by _____ because I _____.

I can contribute by greeting new students because I remember names and I know how a new building feels.

Look-fors

- Is the try realistic for Grade 5 (time, permission, local)?
- Did they connect a real skill, not a superhero identity?

Tip. If a student cannot volunteer outside school, school jobs still count. Do not grade the size of the project.

Week 5: Protective Factors That Help Us Keep Going

My protective-factor card

Kind / One I already have / How it helps me keep going

Person: Person: Ms. Grant's Tuesday table. Place: library nook. Skill: first two questions then hand up. Routine: sleep before the recap.

One protective factor I could strengthen this month (small and realistic)

Ask my uncle to sit with me for ten minutes on Thursday while I start the review sheet.

Exit ticket — Why is “just try harder” a weak plan compared with naming a protective factor?

Trying harder with no sleep already failed. A person, place, skill, or routine gives me a way through — not just more grinding.

Look-fors

- Did they name factors in more than one category?
- Is the “strengthen” item small enough to actually try?

Tip. Do not force family details. School adults and school places are valid protective factors. If a student cannot name a person, help them name one at school.

Week 6: Relating Life Experiences to Well-Being

Relating the pieces

One life experience from this unit or from my year (everyday is enough)

Math this month felt like a wall.

How I practised perseverance (effort, courage, commitment, belief, or a new plan)

I used the first-two-questions skill and went to the Tuesday table. Rest on Wednesday so I could come back Thursday.

A skill I can contribute, or a volunteer idea I still think is realistic

I can help a younger student who is stuck on a first question, because I know how that freeze feels.

One protective factor I will keep using

Tuesday after-school table and sleep before late recaps.

Exit ticket — Because of ____, I practised perseverance by ____, and that helped well-being because ____.

Because math felt like a wall, I practised perseverance by using a skill and a person, and that helped well-being because I stopped calling myself bad at it and I showed up.

Look-fors

- Does the exit sentence include experience, perseverance, and well-being?
- Did they avoid a hero speech?

Tip. Score the unit rubric once now or next class. Do not score every worksheet out of 4. Proficient is the target.